34. Sherring, M.A., *Benares: The Sacred City of the Hindus* (1868), Pilgrims Publishing, 2016, p. 7.
35. Despite many expensive projects, cleaning the Ganga has remained an elusive problem. For a good introduction, see Doron, Assa and Jeffrey, Robin, *Waste of a Nation: Garbage and Growth in India*, Harvard University Press, 2018.
36. Doron, Assa, *Life on the Ganga: Boatmen and the Ritual Economy of Banaras*, Cambridge University Press India, 2013, pp. 27–40.
37. Srivastava, Piyush, 'Narendra Modi Upsets Ganga's Sons', *Telegraph*, January 3, 2019.
38. Doron, Assa, *Life on the Ganga: Boatmen and the Ritual Economy of Banaras*, Cambridge University Press India, 2013, p. 104.
39. The six to seven thousand boatmen are drawn from the city's total Mallah population of perhaps 150,000. If we assume three to four dependents per Mallah, it seems that a fifth of the Mallahs rely on the boating business, while the rest have taken up other professions.
40. Doron, Assa, *Life on the Ganga: Boatmen and the Ritual Economy of Banaras*, Cambridge University Press India, 2013, p. 114.
41. Ibid.
42. Agarwal, Kabir, 'In Modi's Varanasi, the Vishwanath Corridor Is Trampling Kashi's Soul', Wire, March 8, 2019.
43. See these reports for further details: Kumar, Sushil, 'How Modi's Kashi Vishwanath Corridor Is Laying the Ground for Another Babri Incident', *Caravan Magazine*, April 27, 2019; Husain, Yasra, 'Kashi Vishwanath Project Makes Muslims Worried about Mosque', *Times of India*, May 10, 2019.
44. This puzzle and its various answers are discussed in Parry, Jonathan P., *Death in Banaras*, Cambridge University Press, 1994, pp. 27–30.
45. Tavernier, Jean Baptiste (translated by Valentine Ball), *Travels in India* (1676), Macmillan and Company, 1889.
46. Ede, Piers Moore, *Kaleidoscope City: A Year in Varanasi*, Bloomsbury, 2015, p. 10.
47. This essay uses text from a smaller precursor essay by the author. See Arora, Namit, 'As Though We Were Immortal', 3 Quarks Daily, January 30, 2012.